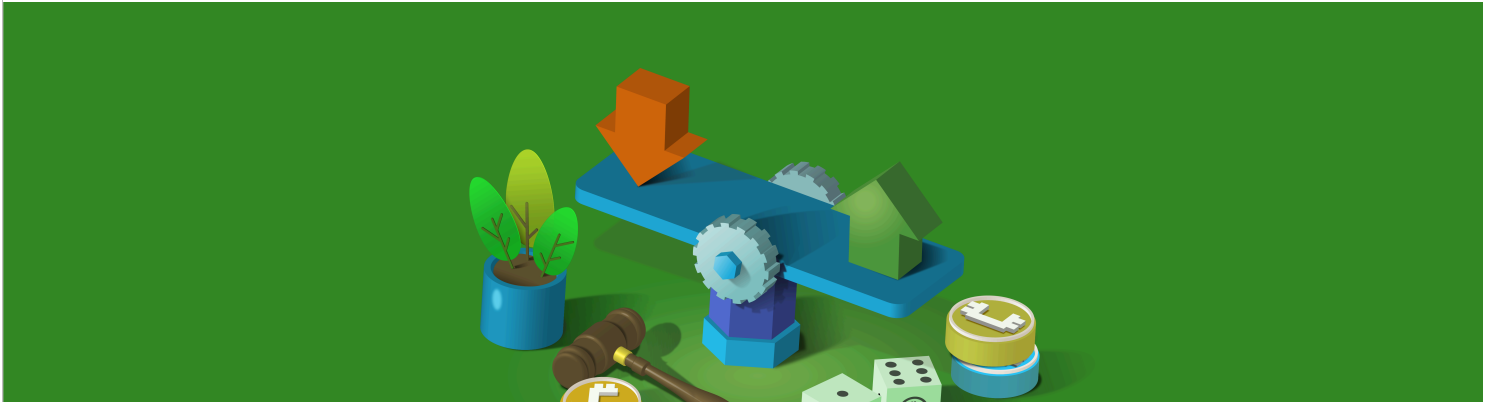


Should I invest in crypto?

Crypto risks and potential benefits to consider.

Fidelity Learn

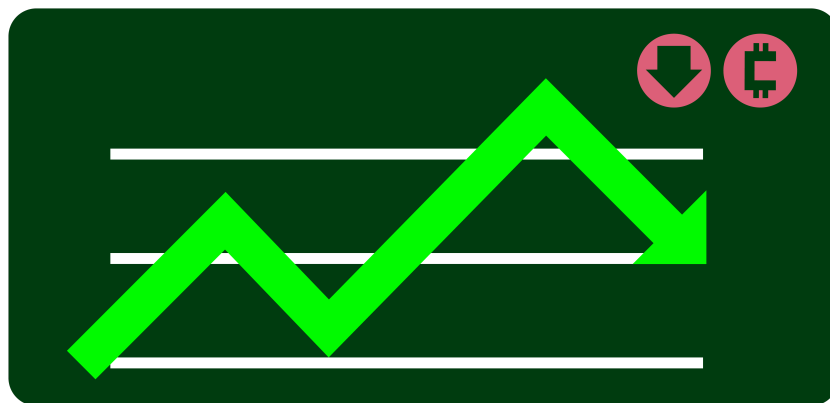


Risks and benefits of cryptocurrency

There are both risks and benefits associated with cryptocurrencies. It's crucial to educate yourself before deciding to determine if you're comfortable with the risks. Here are a few considerations to get you started—note, this is not a full list.

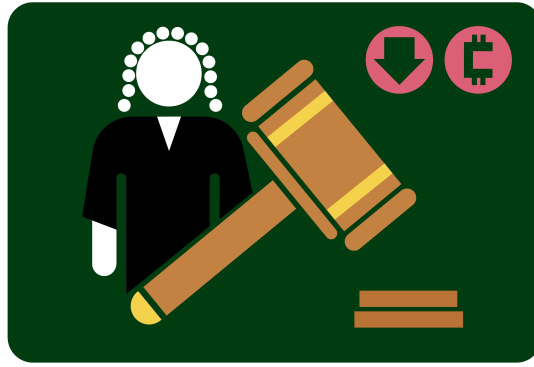
Risks of cryptocurrencies

Volatility



The price of crypto has proven to be extremely volatile, meaning it changes quickly and frequently showing high highs and low lows. While trends can change, there are many factors that contribute to the price fluctuation.

Regulatory uncertainties



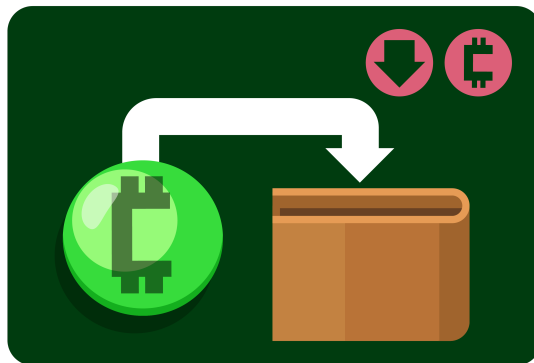
Government regulations around crypto are constantly evolving and may differ based on where you live. Regulations could impact how you use or access your crypto, which can cause volatility and uncertainty. But since crypto is still new, it may take time for policymakers to establish clear, consistent guidelines.

Securities and scams



Not all cryptocurrencies or trading platforms are created equal. Some platforms are more secure than others, and some newer coins could be a higher scam risk than those more established. There is also no protection or insurance for lost or stolen cryptocurrencies, so always research thoroughly before taking action.

Technical



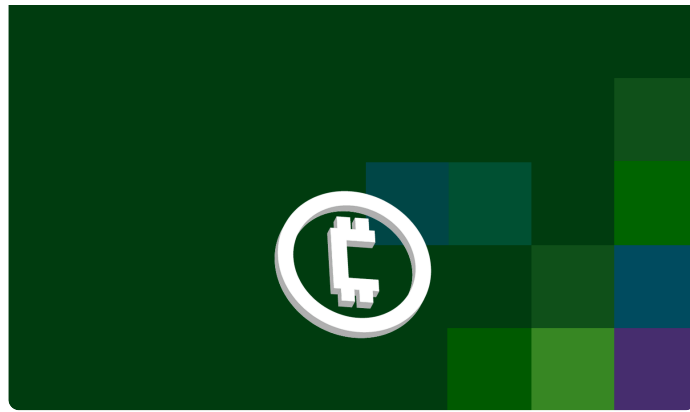
There are two main ways to store your crypto: privately in a non-custodial wallet on a personal device, like an app on your phone or laptop or in a cold storage wallet, or using a third-party custodian, like Fidelity Digital Assets® who offers Fidelity Crypto®.

When storing privately, you are solely responsible for the safety and security of your crypto. If you lose your private key, your hard drive crashes, or a virus corrupts your wallet, you may lose your funds entirely.

Did you know?

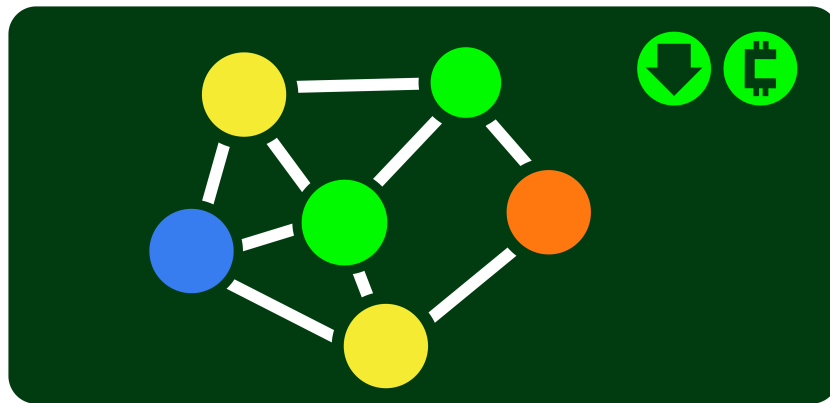
There are over 23,200 cryptocurrencies as of April 2023.¹

Log in



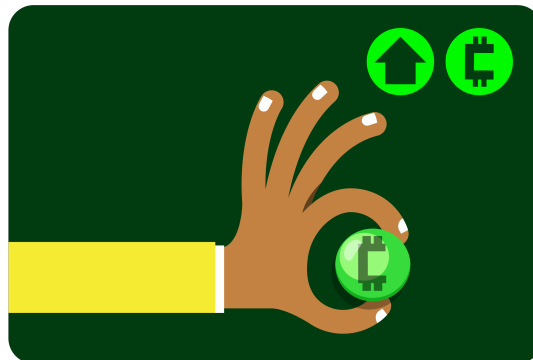
Benefits of cryptocurrencies

Independence



Cryptocurrencies were designed to be decentralized without the control of a single government or central bank. A user may have unrestricted access to their coins, but they also have full responsibility for keeping them safe.

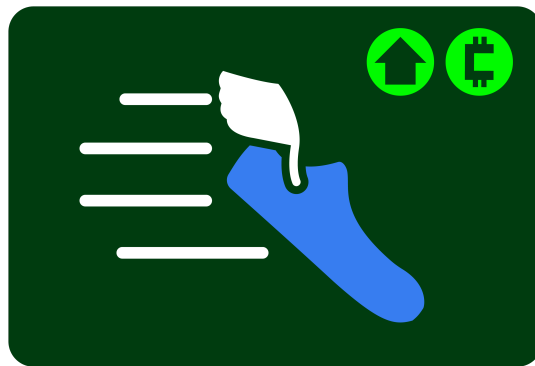
Accessibility



Crypto can be easily accessible to everyone around the clock, even those without access to traditional banking. Only an internet connection and a crypto wallet are required.

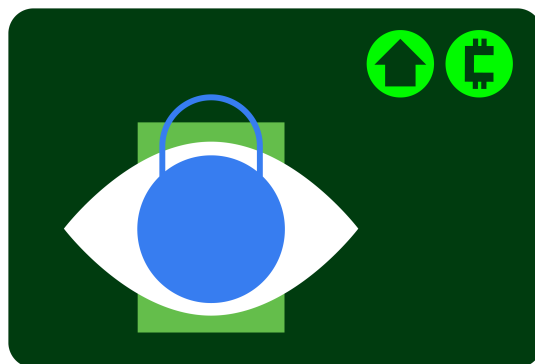
Lower fees and faster time

Log in



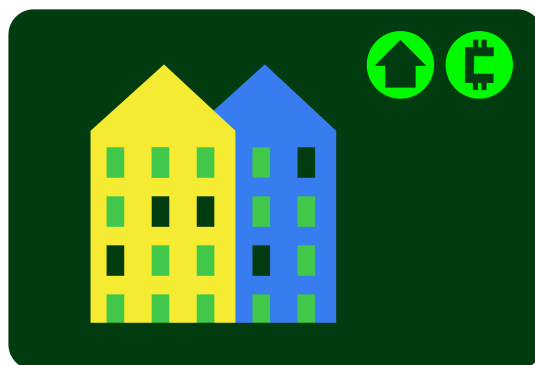
Crypto transactions can have lower fees and faster transfer times than some traditional bank transactions. For example, crypto can potentially avoid high fees associated with global wires and be accessible within minutes, which is a big difference from a standard 24-to-48 hour bank wire. However day-to-day bank transactions, like depositing checks or withdrawing cash are quick and have no fees.

Transparency



Cryptocurrencies operate on blockchain technology that is fully public and immutable, meaning it cannot be changed, manipulated, or deleted, and every transaction can be seen or tracked at any time.

Mainstream support



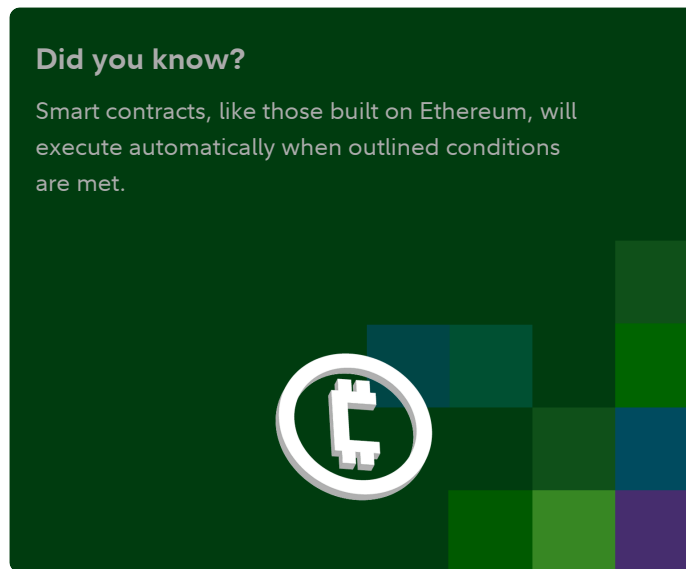
As cryptocurrencies grow in popularity, mainstream financial institutions and businesses have begun to show interest by offering and/or accepting cryptocurrencies. However, unlike traditional finance that has been around for 300+ years, cryptocurrencies are still in their infancy phase and their future remains uncertain.

High return potential

Log in



Although cryptocurrencies are highly volatile, they have also yielded high returns in the past depending on when purchased. But it's important to understand that past performance never guarantees or suggests future results.



The bottom line

Not all coins or platforms are created equal. Crypto is a new, highly volatile asset class, and you need to be comfortable with the risks before taking action. Educate yourself thoroughly before deciding and only invest if you are prepared to lose the entire investment.

Trade with Fidelity Crypto®

Buy, sell, and transfer crypto in the same app where
you trade stocks and ETFs.

Open an account

More to explore

[Log in](#)

Crypto at Fidelity

Learn about Fidelity's approach and explore investment ideas.

Covering Crypto Livestream

Get in the know and register for the next event.

Subscribe to Decode Crypto

Clarity on crypto every month. Build your knowledge with education for all levels.

All fields are required.

First name

Last name

Email address

Subscribe

[Finding stock and sector ideas](#)

[Investing for beginners](#)

[Crypto](#)

1. "All Coins," CoinMarketCap, September 2022, <https://coinmarketcap.com/coins/views/all/>

The images, graphs, tools, and videos are for illustrative purposes only.

Fidelity Crypto[®] is offered by Fidelity Digital Assets[®].

Investing involves risk, including risk of total loss.

Crypto as an asset class is highly volatile, can become illiquid at any time, and is for investors with a high risk tolerance. Crypto may also be more susceptible to market manipulation than securities. Crypto is not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation, the Securities Investor Protection Corporation, or any other government agency, and is not an obligation of any bank. Investors in crypto do not benefit from the same regulatory protections applicable to registered securities.

Fidelity Crypto[®] accounts and custody and trading of crypto in such accounts are provided by Fidelity Digital Assets, National Association, which is a national trust bank.

Brokerage services in support of securities trading are provided by Fidelity Brokerage Services LLC ("FBS"), and related custody services are provided by National Financial Services LLC ("NFS"), each a registered broker-dealer and member NYSE and SIPC.

Neither FBS nor NFS offer crypto as a direct investment nor provide trading or custody services for such assets.

Fidelity Crypto and Fidelity Digital Assets are registered service marks of FMR LLC.

Fidelity Brokerage Services LLC, Member NYSE, [SIPC](#), 900 Salem Street, Smithfield, RI 02917

1050947.4.0



[Careers](#) [News Releases](#) [About Fidelity](#) [International](#)

Copyright 1998-2026 FMR LLC. All Rights Reserved.

[Terms of Use](#) [Privacy](#) [Security](#) [Site Map](#) [Accessibility](#) [Contact Us](#)

[Share Your Screen](#) [Disclosures](#)

[Manage My Targeting/Advertising Cookies](#)

[This is for persons in the US only.](#)

Stay Connected

Locate an Investor Center by ZIP Code

Search

